

Q1: Define statistics and explain its importance in the context of Shariah research.

Answer: -

According to Croxon and Cowden: -

'Statistics may be defined as, "the science of collection, presentation, analysis and interpretation of a numerical data."

Arthur Lyon Bowley:

Statistics is defined as, "Numerical statistics for facts in any department of inquiry placed in relation to each other."

* Importances

In Islamic research, statistics is not only just a mathematical tool, it is essential for actualizing the objectives of Islamic laws.

① Empirical Evidence for fatwas:—

Islamic scholars need accurate statistical data to issue relevant and practical fatwas on contemporary economic or social issues.

② Zakat and Waqf Management:—

Statistics is vital for calculating the poverty line, determining the Nisab in modern currencies, estimating potential Zakat collection and measuring the socioeconomic impact of Waqf distributions.

3. Islamic Finance & Economics:—

It is used for risk management in Mudarabah and Musharakah contracts, forecasting market trends for Islamic bonds, and ensuring Shariah-compliant asset allocation.

④ Socio-Economic Development:—

To fulfill the Islamic mandate of circulating wealth and eradicating poverty, researchers use statistics to track income inequality, employment rates and access to basic needs within Muslim communities.

Question ② Discuss the use of statistics in everyday life and its limitations.

Answer:—

The use of statistics in everyday life:—

① Personal finance:—

Managing family budgets, calculating ^{accurate} Zakat and planning debt to avoid Riba.

② Halal Consumption:—

Relying on data and probability to verify Halal

Food and medicine certifications,

(u) Community planning:-

Using local demographics to plan Mosque expansions or Islamic schools.

* Limitations:—

① Doesn't deal with isolated measurement:-

Deals with groups data, not single events.

Ex: Taking a single and specific fatwa then generalizing it to all situations, is wrong.

② Deals only with quantitative aspects:—

Cannot measure qualitative abstracts.

Ex: Statistics can count how many people attend prayer but cannot measure their spiritual sincerity.

③ True only on averages.—

Averages hide individual realities. Ex: A high average income might suggest everyone can

~~Question 3:-~~ Zakat, overlooking specific poor individuals who still fall below the Nisab.

④ Just a Tool:—

It is a means to achieve welfare, not an absolute truth.

Ex: Low fasting statistics might not mean disobedience, it ignores unable persons to fast due to valid personal/medical Shariah reasons.

⑤ Can be misused:—

Data can be manipulated for false narratives.

Ex: Showing a decline in Hijab-wearing to wrongly argue against the Shariah requirement of hijab.

Q- Difference between primary and secondary data.

Basis of comparison	Primary data	Secondary data
Meaning	Data collected first-hand by the researchers for a specific purpose.	Data already collected and published by others.
Source	Surveys, interviews, observation, experiments	Books, journals, reports, websites.
Originality	Original and raw.	Already processed.
Purpose	Collected for current research	Collected for some other purpose.
Cost	Expensive.	Less expensive.
Time required.	Time consuming	Saves time.
Control	Researcher has full control over data collection	No control over how data was collected.

Suitability	Highly suitable to research objectives.	May not perfectly fit research objectives.
Exam:	Questionnaire, personal interview, survey.	Govt report, data, Research articles.

Q = source of collecting secondary data.

1. International organizations: —

— Reports from IDB, IFSB.

2. Government Bodies: —

Data from Central Banks, Census Bureaus,
— National Zakat / Waqf Boards.

③ Academic Journals: —

Published research articles in Islamic Economies.

4. Corporate Reports: —

Annual financial statements and Shariah
Boards reports of Islamic Bank.

Shortcut Method

Age	No. of worker (F)	Mid value (x)	d	fd
18-22	120	20	-4	-480
22-26	125	24	-3	-375
26-30	280	28	-2	-560
30-34	260	32	-1	-260
34-38	155	36 (A)	0	0
38-42	184	40	1	184
42-46	162	44	2	324
46-50	86	48	3	258
50-54	75	52	4	300
54-58	53	56	5	265
n = 1500				= -344

Indirect method of finding out

$$\text{mean} = A + c \times \frac{\sum fd}{n}$$

$$= 36 + 4 \times \frac{-344}{1500}$$

$$= 36 - \frac{1376}{1500}$$

$$= 36 - 0.917$$

$$= 35.08 \text{ years. (Ans.)}$$